Sociology - Structural Correspondence with the Five-Stage Model

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Sociology

Structural correspondence survey with the five-stage model (Ba, Nami, En, Uzu, Taba)

Survey Overview

- **Scope**: 11 major theories in sociology
- **Research question**: Do theories in sociology structurally correspond to the five-stage model?
- **Results**: Strong correspondence 8, Partial correspondence 2, Conditional correspondence 1

Overview of the Five-Stage Model

Stage	Definition
Ba (Field)	An undifferentiated state. Initial conditions where neither direction nor structure has yet been determined
Nami (Wave)	A stage of exploration where multiple directions diverge and compete
En (Edge)	A state of tension where opposing elements coexist without converging to either side. A place where elements meet at boundaries, influence each other, and relationships emerge
Uzu (Vortex)	A stage where new coherence (order) spontaneously arises from within tension
Taba (Bundle)	A stage where form is established and stabilizes as a reusable structure

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Overall Structural Correspondence

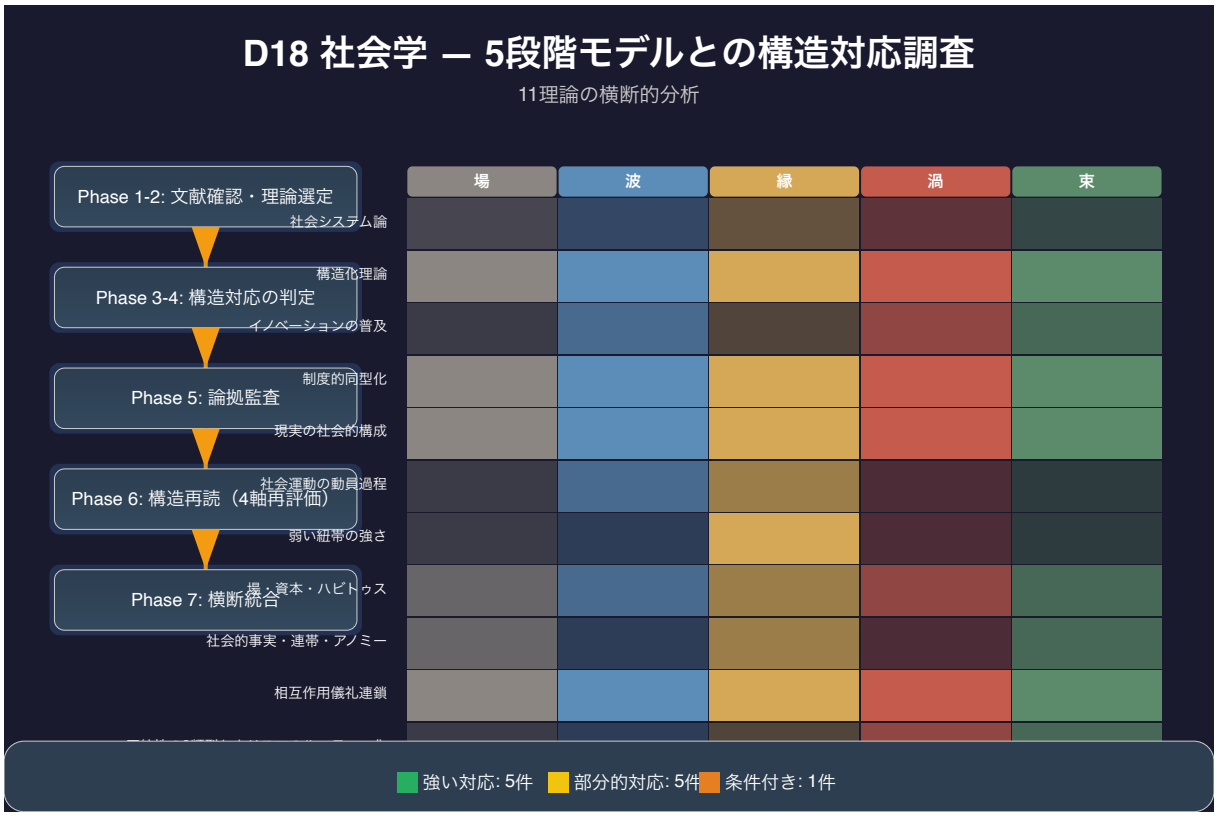

Figure 1: Domain — Research Overview Infographic

#	Theory/Concept	Proponent	Corresponding Stages	Assessment
1	Social systems theory	Luhmann (1984)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba (abstract)	Conditional correspondence
2	Structuration theory	Giddens (1984)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba→Ba cycle	Strong structural correspondence
3	Diffusion of innovations	Rogers (1962/2003)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba	Strong structural correspondence
4	Institutional isomorphism	DiMaggio & Powell (1983)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba	Strong structural correspondence
5	The social construction of reality	Berger & Luckmann (1966)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba→Ba cycle	Partial correspondence
6	Social movement mobilization process	McCarthy & Zald / Tarrow	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba→Ba cycle	Strong structural correspondence
7	The strength of weak ties	Granovetter (1973)	Specialized in En	Strong structural correspondence
8	Field, capital, habitus	Bourdieu (1979)	Ba→Nami→En-Uzu→Taba→Ba cycle	Partial correspondence
9	Social facts, solidarity, anomie	Durkheim (1893)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba	Strong structural correspondence
10	Interaction ritual chains	Collins (2004)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba→Ba cycle	Strong structural correspondence

#	Theory/Concept	Proponent	Corresponding Stages	Assessment
11	Three types of legitimate authority	Weber (1922)	Ba→Nami→En→Uzu→Taba	Strong structural correspondence

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Key Entry 1: Structuration Theory (Giddens)

- Anthony Giddens responded to the central debate in sociology — "which comes first, structure or agency?" — with the concept of the "duality of structure." His claim is that structure both constrains and enables action, and that rather than existing outside action, it is continuously reproduced within action.
- **As fact**: Giddens (1984) *The Constitution of Society* presents the "duality of structure" as its core concept. Structure consists of "rules and resources," with rules divided into interpretive schemes for meaning and norms for legitimation of action, and resources divided into material allocative resources and human authoritative resources. Actors act using practical knowledge about the conditions and consequences of their own actions and others' actions, while continuously "reflexively monitoring" their own actions and those of others.
- **As reading**: Here we read as structural feature the cyclical recursion in which structure and agency mutually determine each other. The level of similarity is structure, and we focus on the very bidirectional determining relationship of "action reproduces structure, structure constrains action."
- **As interpretation**: The phase in which the set of latent rules and resources constitutes the conditions of action corresponds to Ba. The phase in which differences in interpretation and conflicts arise in action situations corresponds to Nami. The phase in which rules are operated in mutual interaction and relationships are woven together corresponds to En. The phase in which repeated practices arise as institutional patterns corresponds to Uzu; and the phase in which reproduced institutions orient the next action conditions corresponds to Taba. The cycle in which Taba constitutes the next Ba is the central proposition of this theory itself. Giddens states that "structure is both constraining and enabling," explicitly describing the dual aspect that Taba not only restricts but also makes possible the next creation.

Key Entry 2: Institutional Isomorphism and Organizational Fields (DiMaggio & Powell)

- DiMaggio and Powell took up the question of why organizations become increasingly similar to one another over time. Their claim that institutional pressures rather than market competition homogenize organizations has had a major influence on organizational research.
- **As fact**: DiMaggio & Powell (1983) identified three mechanisms that cause organizational isomorphism: coercive isomorphism (legal regulations and political pressure); mimetic isomorphism (mimicking successful models amid uncertainty); and normative isomorphism (homogenization through professional education and training). They also defined the "organizational field" as "a recognized area of institutional life" formed by suppliers, consumers, regulatory agencies, and similar organizations, and described the "structuration" of this field as consisting of four elements: increased mutual interaction, emergence of dominant and coalition structures, increased information load, and development of mutual awareness.
- **As reading**: Here we read as structural feature the concrete enumeration of components of the organizational field structuration process. The level of similarity is process, and we focus on the sequence in which an unstructured organizational aggregate becomes structured under institutional pressure.
- **As interpretation**: The state in which diverse organizations coexist without mutual interconnection corresponds to Ba. The agitation of organizations by pressures of legitimacy, uncertainty, and professional norms corresponds to Nami. The structuration of the field — increased mutual interaction, emergence of coalition structures, circulation of information, development of mutual awareness — corresponds to En. This description of four elements is one of the most concrete descriptions of "En" confirmed in this survey. The phase in which the "correct organizational type"

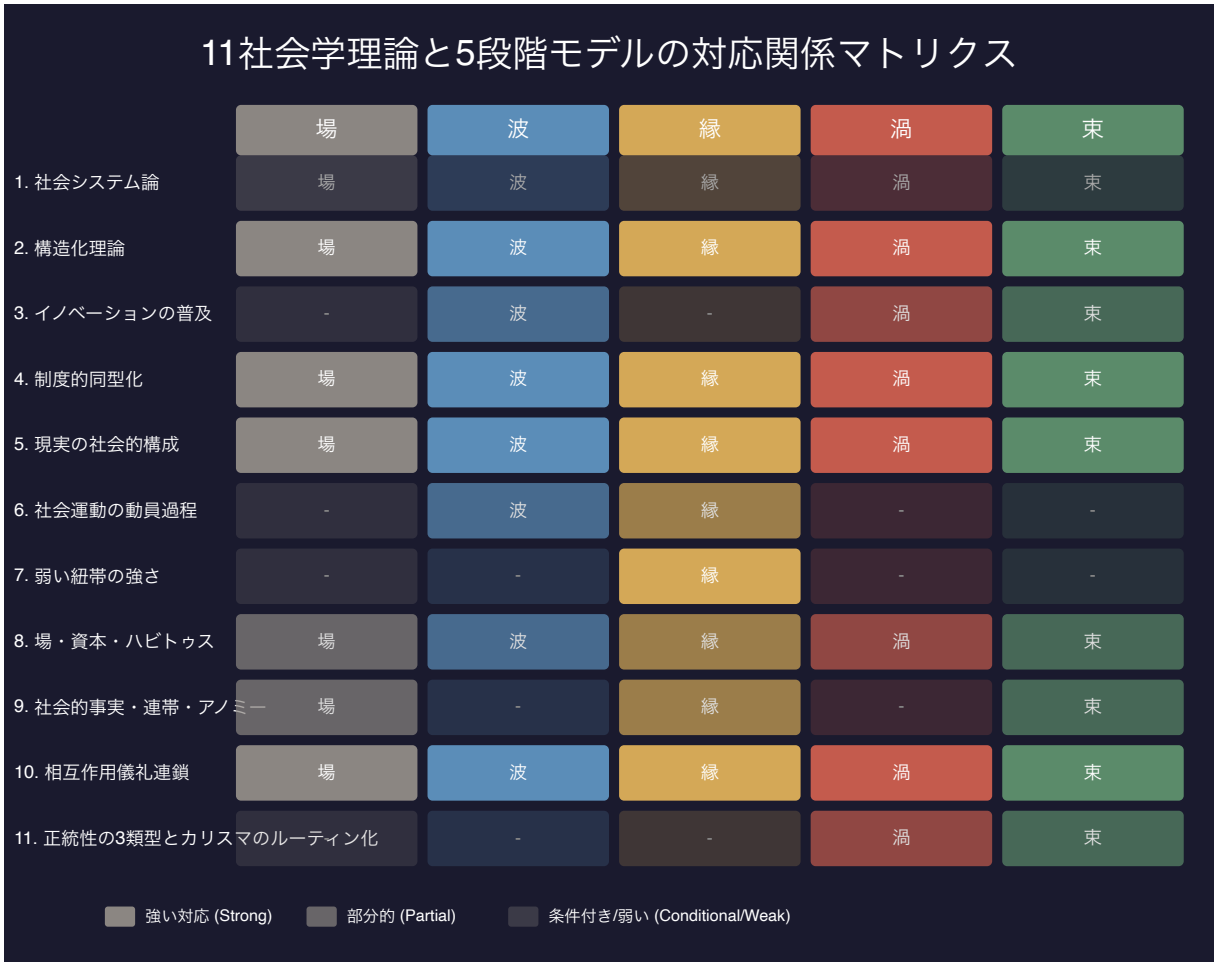

Figure 2: Domain — Theory x 5-Stage Correspondence Matrix

is made visible through the synergy of three mechanisms corresponds to Uzu; and the reproduction of isomorphized practices and standards through hiring, evaluation, and training corresponds to Taba.
- However, the focus of this theory is "homogenization" rather than "creation." The process from diversity toward homogeneity differs in direction from the "from undifferentiated to differentiated and structured" that the five stages typically describe. Institutional isomorphism can also be read as an "anti-creative process," and has its own value in showing the concrete mechanisms by which Taba constrains diversity.

Key Entry 3: The Strength of Weak Ties (Granovetter)

- Mark Granovetter demonstrated the counterintuitive finding that "weak ties" in social networks are more effective than "strong ties" in transmitting new information.
- **As fact**: Granovetter (1973) found, from a study of job-seeking behavior, that more people found jobs through acquaintances they rarely met (weak ties) rather than close friends (strong ties). People connected by strong ties tend to share the same information, but weak ties "bridge" different clusters. Granovetter (1985) also argued that economic action is "embedded" in networks of social relations and is neither purely rational nor purely normative.
- **As reading**: Here we read as structural feature the bridging structure that connects different groups. The level of similarity is structure, and we focus on the arrangement of pathways through which heterogeneous information circulates on the network.
- **As interpretation**: Weak ties are the most pure sociological formulation of En in the five-stage model. Functioning as a "bridge" connecting different clusters (groups each forming a Ba), new information and resources cross this bridge and flow, opening possibilities that were not contained in existing order. The paradox that "weaker relationships are more useful" shows that En is not strong binding but an interface where heterogeneous elements come into contact.

Cross-Cutting Patterns

- Looking across sociology, four patterns repeatedly appear
- **First, the diversity of types of "En"**
- **Second, the cycle from Taba back to Ba**
- **Third, the continuity of scale from micro to macro**

Unresolved Questions

- Bourdieu's "field" (champ, a structured space of competition) and the five-stage model's "Ba" (undifferentiated space of possibility) are the same name but different concepts. Continuing to use "Ba" without clarifying this conceptual difference will cause confusion. Whether the definition of Ba in the five stages needs to be expanded to Ba that already contains some pre-structure, or whether it should be maintained strictly as an undifferentiated state, has not yet been settled.
- The relationship between the "simultaneity" of Berger & Luckmann's three moments and the "phasic order" of the five-stage model is unresolved. If the five stages are read as phases of transformation, correspondence is possible, but read strictly as temporal order it damages the main point of the theory (dialectical circulation). How far this re-reading is legitimate requires further examination.
- If Collins' "emotional energy" is a micro version of Taba, then Taba would accumulate not only at the institutional and normative level but also at the bodily and emotional level. How far to extend the definition of Taba requires cross-reference with other domains (neuroscience, psychology).
- DiMaggio & Powell's institutional isomorphism is a process moving "from diversity toward homogeneity," differing in direction from the "from undifferentiated to differentiated and structured" that the five-stage model typically describes. Whether the scope of the five-stage model should include the mechanism of "anti-creation" remains as a theoretically important question.

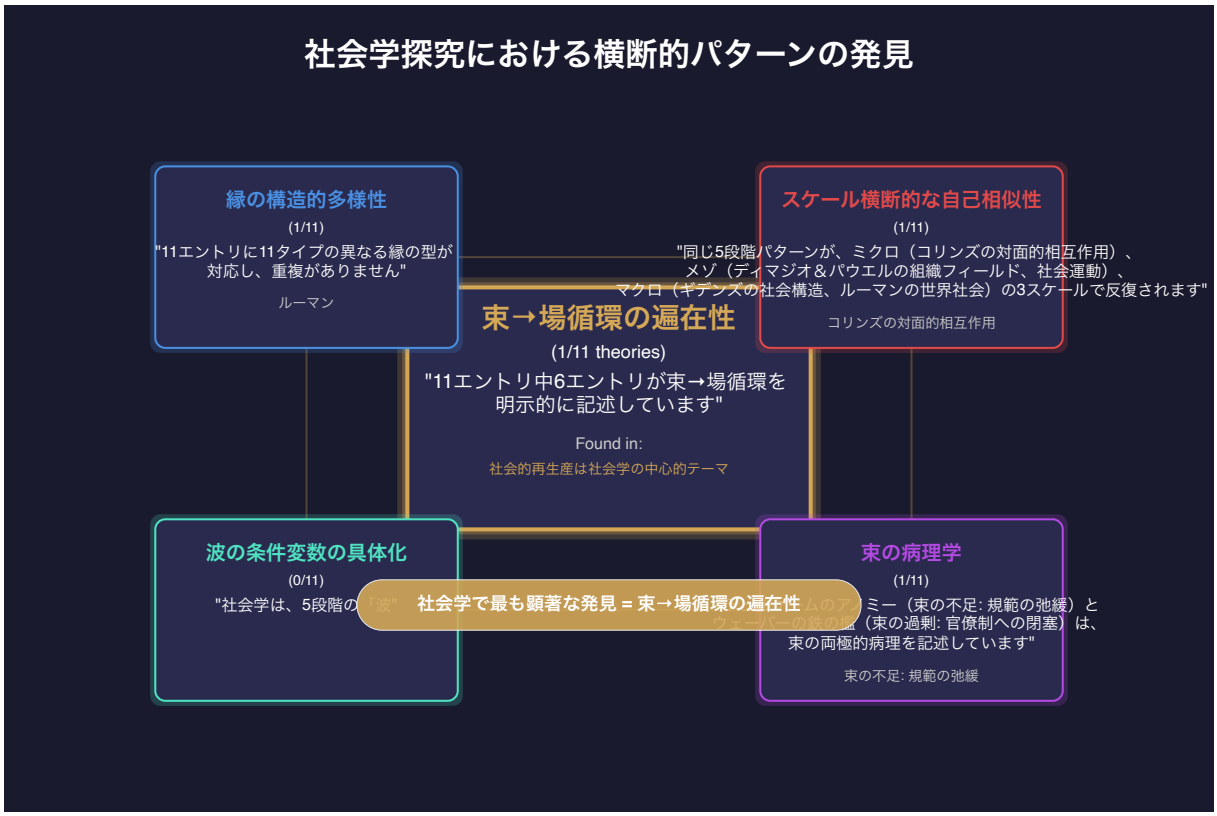

Figure 3: Domain — Cross-Cutting Patterns Diagram

Conclusion

- This survey confirmed that sociology is a domain with strong overall structural similarity to the five-stage model
- The greatest contribution that sociology shows to the five-stage model is the richness of concretization of “En”
- The second contribution is that the cycle from Taba to Ba is independently described in multiple theories
- The third contribution is that isomorphic processes have been confirmed at multiple scales from micro to macro